

A06 Entertainment and Media Module Reflection

1. Industry Overview

The entertainment and media industry focuses on creating and distributing content such as movies, television shows, music, video games, news, and online media. Its goal is to inform, entertain, and engage audiences through different forms of digital and traditional content. Today, this industry serves billions of people around the world through platforms like Netflix, Spotify, YouTube, TikTok, and many others.

This industry is especially relevant today because technology has changed how content is produced and consumed. People can access entertainment almost instantly from their phones, computers, and smart devices. Artificial intelligence is becoming a major part of this transformation by helping creators produce content more efficiently and helping companies better understand what audiences want to watch, listen to, or read. According to the course materials, AI is being used in music creation, writing, visual design, recommendation systems, and deepfake technology, making it one of the most influential technologies currently shaping the entertainment world.

2. Current AI Trends

One of the most visible AI trends in entertainment is the growth of generative AI for music creation. AI-powered tools such as AIVA and Amper Music can generate melodies, harmonies, and even complete musical compositions. The module explains that these tools are already being used for applications such as film scoring and background music for games and videos.

What I found interesting is that AI is not necessarily replacing musicians but often acting as a creative assistant. The article on generative AI and music explains that artists can use AI to overcome creative blocks, test new ideas, and experiment with sounds they might not have considered before. A well-known example is The Beatles' song *Now and Then*, where AI was used to isolate John Lennon's voice from an old recording and help complete the song decades later.

Another major trend is personalized recommendation systems. Streaming platforms such as Netflix and Spotify rely heavily on AI algorithms to recommend content based on a user's behavior. The systems analyze things such as viewing history, ratings, listening habits, and user interactions to predict what content a person is likely to enjoy.

Netflix uses these systems to increase viewer engagement and even personalizes thumbnails to attract different users. Spotify's Discover Weekly playlist is another example, using machine learning techniques to recommend new music that matches a listener's preferences. These recommendation systems solve the problem of information overload by helping users find content that is relevant to them without having to search through thousands of options.

A third trend is the use of deepfakes and AI-generated digital humans. Deepfake technology allows AI to create realistic images, videos, and voices that closely resemble real people. In entertainment, this technology has been used for special effects, de-aging actors, and even recreating performers who have passed away.

The BBC article discussed how AI technology is being used to digitally recreate actor James Dean for future film projects, even though he died nearly 70 years ago. Another article described companies in China creating AI-powered replicas of deceased loved ones that can interact with family members through conversations. These examples show how advanced AI-generated media has become and how quickly the technology is evolving.

3. Ethical Implications

One ethical concern that stands out is job displacement. AI can now assist with writing, music composition, visual design, and even acting-related tasks. While this increases efficiency, it also raises concerns about whether creative professionals will lose opportunities in the future. The course materials mention the possibility of composers and other creators being replaced by automated systems.

The BBC article also highlights concerns from actors and voice actors who worry that AI-generated performances could reduce the demand for human performers. If studios can

reuse digital versions of performers indefinitely, there may be fewer opportunities for new talent to enter the industry. On the other hand, AI may also create new jobs related to AI development, content editing, and digital production. This makes the issue more complex than simply saying AI is either good or bad for employment.

Another major concern involves privacy, consent, and ownership. Deepfake technology raises important questions about who owns a person's image, voice, and identity. The article about digital replicas of deceased individuals asks whether someone who has passed away can truly consent to being recreated through AI.

Similarly, the BBC article discusses how the rights to a person's likeness often fall to family members or estates after death, which can create difficult ethical situations. Even if something is technically legal, it may not reflect what that person would have wanted. This becomes especially concerning when AI-generated content is used for commercial purposes.

Transparency is another issue. As AI-generated content becomes increasingly realistic, it may become difficult for audiences to know what is authentic and what is artificially created. The module specifically mentions that deepfakes can contribute to misinformation and reduce public trust in the media. If people begin questioning every video or image they see online, trust in digital media could decline significantly.

4. Future Trends

Over the next five to ten years, I think AI will become deeply integrated into almost every part of the entertainment and media industry. Instead of being viewed as a separate tool, AI will likely become part of the standard workflow for creators, editors, musicians, and producers.

One area that will continue growing is AI-assisted content creation. Musicians may use AI to generate ideas; filmmakers may rely on AI for visual effects and editing, and writers may use language models to help develop story concepts. The result could be faster production times and lower costs for creating high-quality content.

Personalization will also become more sophisticated. Recommendation systems will likely become better at understanding user preferences and delivering highly customized experiences. In the future, entertainment platforms may even generate personalized content specifically designed for individual users.

Another trend will be the rise of digital performers and virtual influencers. The course materials discuss AI-generated influencers, while the assigned readings show that AI can already recreate deceased actors and family members. It is possible that future movies, advertisements, and online content will feature AI-generated personalities that become as recognizable as real celebrities.

At the same time, society will need stronger regulations and ethical guidelines. Questions about ownership, privacy, consent, and misinformation will become even more important as AI-generated media becomes harder to distinguish from reality. Finding a balance between innovation and responsible use will be one of the biggest challenges facing the industry.

5. My Reflection

The most surprising thing I learned from this module was how far AI-generated media has already progressed. I knew AI could generate text and images, but I did not realize it was advanced enough to recreate deceased actors for films or allow people to have conversations with AI versions of loved ones who have passed away. That was both impressive and slightly unsettling at the same time.

Personally, I think I would enjoy working in this industry because it combines technology with creativity. I like the idea of using AI as a tool to help people create new forms of entertainment rather than simply automating everything. At the same time, learning about ethical concerns made me realize that these technologies need clear boundaries and responsible oversight.

Overall, I think AI will continue to change entertainment in ways we can barely imagine right now. The opportunities are exciting, but the industry will need to make sure that innovation does not come at the expense of creativity, privacy, or trust.

